

Survey Instrument

Workplace Well-Being in Content Review and BPO Roles — Anonymous Research Survey

Platform:	Google Forms — anonymous (email collection disabled)
Administration period:	2024, Hyderabad BPO community
Sample:	N=60 BPO and content review professionals (final)
Pilot:	n=5 (not included in final sample), administered Week 1 prior to main distribution
Sections:	A: Demographics (8 items) · B: MBI-GS9 (9 items) · C: PHQ-9 (9 items) · D: PCL-5 subset (10 items)
Estimated time:	10–12 minutes
Eligibility:	BPO/content review/T&S role; UGC review as at least occasional function; minimum 1 month in role
Ethics:	Informed consent required to proceed. Crisis resources displayed after C9 and at survey close

Documentation note: This document reproduces the survey instrument as administered via Google Forms. Response options, section headers, scale anchors, and the consent statement are shown exactly as they appeared to respondents. The post-C9 crisis resource display is reproduced in Section C. This document should be read alongside GuardianShield_DataAnalysis.xlsx (Raw Data sheet) and GuardianShield_Report.pdf for the full research record.

PRE-SURVEY CONSENT STATEMENT

Displayed to all respondents before any survey questions. Respondents were required to click 'I understand and agree to participate' before proceeding to Section A.

Thank you for taking part in this research. This survey is part of an independent academic project examining the psychological well-being of content review and BPO professionals. All responses are completely anonymous — no names, email addresses, or identifying information are collected or stored. Your participation is voluntary. You may stop at any time without any consequence. This survey takes approximately 10–12 minutes to complete. The results will be used only for academic research purposes. Aggregate findings may be shared with BPO HR departments as recommendations, with all individual responses fully anonymised. **If any questions raise personal concerns about your mental health, please reach out to:** iCall: 9152987821 (Mon–Sat, 8am–10pm) NIMHANS Helpline: 080-46110007 Vandrevalla Foundation 24/7 Helpline: 1860-2662-345 By clicking the button below, you confirm that you understand the above and voluntarily agree to participate.

✓ I understand and agree to participate

SECTION A — Demographics and Role Context

*Purpose: Enables cross-tabulation of findings by tenure, function, exposure level, and support access. 8 questions.
All multiple-choice unless noted.*

A1

How long have you been in your current or most recent BPO/content review role?

- ☐ Less than 3 months
- ☐ 3–6 months
- ☐ 6–12 months
- ☐ 1–2 years
- ☐ More than 2 years

A2

Which best describes your primary job function?

- ☐ Content moderation / UGC review
- ☐ Customer support (inbound)
- ☐ Customer support (outbound/sales)
- ☐ Quality assurance
- ☐ Trust & Safety operations
- ☐ Other (please specify): _____

A3

On average, how many hours per day do you spend reviewing user-submitted content (posts, videos, comments, images)?

- ☐ 0 hours — not part of my role
- ☐ Less than 1 hour
- ☐ 1–2 hours
- ☐ 3–4 hours
- ☐ 5–6 hours
- ☐ More than 6 hours

A4

Which types of content have you reviewed as part of your work? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ Graphic violence
- ☐ Sexual content
- ☐ Hate speech or harassment
- ☐ Self-harm or suicide-related content
- ☐ Child exploitation content
- ☐ Misinformation or dangerous health claims
- ☐ Violent extremism or terrorism
- ☐ None of the above

A5

Did your employer provide any formal training on how to cope with exposure to disturbing content before you started the role?

- ☐ Yes, comprehensive training provided

- ☐ Yes, brief training provided (less than 1 hour)
- ☐ No training was provided
- ☐ I was not exposed to disturbing content in my role

A6

Do you currently have access to a counsellor or mental health professional through your employer?

- ☐ Yes, and I have used this service
- ☐ Yes, but I have not used it
- ☐ No, this is not provided
- ☐ I don't know if this is available

A7

Can you request to be reassigned away from disturbing content categories if you feel overwhelmed?

- ☐ Yes, this is formally allowed
- ☐ Informally yes, but it's not an official process
- ☐ No, rotation is not available
- ☐ I'm not sure

A8

Are you considering leaving your current role in the next 6 months?

- ☐ Definitely yes
- ☐ Probably yes
- ☐ Probably not
- ☐ Definitely not
- ☐ I'm currently not employed in this sector

Note on A8: Intent-to-leave is the most operationally relevant metric for a BPO HR team. Correlation between burnout scores and A8 constitutes the business case analysis in the report.

SECTION B — MBI-GS9: Maslach Burnout Inventory (9-Item General Survey)

Source: Maslach & Jackson (1981); shortened version validated by Wang et al. (2024). Gold standard for occupational burnout measurement across all professions. Three subscales: Exhaustion (B1–B3), Cynicism (B4–B6), Professional Efficacy (B7–B9). IMPORTANT: No clinical cutoffs are used. Scores are interpreted comparatively within this sample only.

The following questions ask about your feelings related to your work. There are no right or wrong answers. Please rate how often you experience each feeling using the scale below.

Response scale | 0 = Never · 1 = A few times a year or less · 2 = Once a month or less · 3 = A few times a month · 4 = Once a week · 5 = A few times a week · 6 = Every day

0 Never	1 Few times/yr	2 Once/month	3 Few times/month	4 Once/week	5 Few times/week	6 Every day
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EXHAUSTION SUBSCALE

B1

I feel emotionally drained by my work.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

B2

I feel used up at the end of the workday.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

B3

I feel tired when I get up in the morning and have to face another day on the job.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

CYNICISM SUBSCALE

B4

I have become less interested in my work since I started this job.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

B5

I have become less enthusiastic about my work.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

B6

I doubt the significance of my work.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

EFFICACY SUBSCALE

B7

In my opinion, I am good at my job.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

B8

I feel stimulated when I achieve something at work.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

B9

I have accomplished many worthwhile things in this job.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4	5	6

Scoring note: *MBI_Exhaustion* = B1+B2+B3 (0–18). *MBI_Cynicism* = B4+B5+B6 (0–18). *MBI_Efficacy* = B7+B8+B9 (0–18, higher = LESS burnout). No clinical cutoffs — used for within-sample comparison only.

SECTION C — PHQ-9: Patient Health Questionnaire (9 Items)

Source: Kroenke et al. (2001). Validated self-administered depression severity screen. Freely available for research use (no licence required). IMPORTANT: Item C9 (passive suicidal ideation) requires crisis resource display — see below.

Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by any of the following problems?

Response scale | 0 = Not at all · 1 = Several days · 2 = More than half the days · 3 = Nearly every day

C1

Little interest or pleasure in doing things.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

C2

Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

C3

Trouble falling or staying asleep, or sleeping too much.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

C4

Feeling tired or having little energy.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

C5

Poor appetite or overeating.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

C6

Feeling bad about yourself — or that you are a failure or have let yourself or your family down.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

C7

Trouble concentrating on things, such as reading the newspaper or watching television.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

C8

Moving or speaking so slowly that other people could have noticed? Or the opposite — being so fidgety or restless that you have been moving around a lot more than usual.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

■■■ C9: Passive Suicidal Ideation Screening Item ■■■

C9

Thoughts that you would be better off dead, or of hurting yourself in some way.

☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3

■ CRISIS RESOURCES — displayed immediately after C9 in the Google Form: If you answered 'Several days' or more for the question above, please reach out for support: iCall: 9152987821

(Mon–Sat, 8am–10pm) NIMHANS Helpline: 080-46110007 Vandrevala Foundation 24/7 Helpline: 1860-2662-345

Scoring note: PHQ9_Total = C1+C2+...+C9 (0–27). Threshold ≥ 10 = moderate depression signal (Kroenke et al., 2001). C9 reported separately — see Section 7 of Research Report.

SECTION D — PCL-5: PTSD Checklist, 10-Item Research Subset

Source: Weathers et al. (2013). 10-item subset from the full 20-item PCL-5. Covers Clusters B (Intrusion), C (Avoidance), D (Negative Cognitions), and E (Arousal/Reactivity). Subset score range: 0–40. Elevated threshold ≥ 19 (proportional to full-scale threshold of 38). RESULT: Zero respondents scored ≥ 19 . Maximum observed = 14. See Report Section 8.

The following questions ask about difficulties you may have had after being exposed to upsetting or disturbing content at work. Please think about your experiences over the past month when answering.

Response scale | 0 = Not at all · 1 = A little bit · 2 = Moderately · 3 = Quite a bit · 4 = Extremely

CLUSTER B — INTRUSION

D1

Repeated, disturbing, and unwanted memories of content you have reviewed at work.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

D2

Repeated, disturbing dreams of content you have reviewed.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

D3

Suddenly feeling or acting as if content you reviewed was happening again (as if you were reliving it).

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

CLUSTER C — AVOIDANCE

D4

Avoiding memories, thoughts, or feelings related to disturbing content you have reviewed.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

D5

Avoiding external reminders of disturbing content — people, places, conversations, activities, objects, or situations.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

CLUSTER D — NEGATIVE COGNITIONS / MOOD

D6

Having strong negative feelings such as fear, horror, anger, guilt, or shame related to your work.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

D7

Loss of interest in activities you used to enjoy.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

D8

Feeling distant or cut off from other people.

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
0	1	2	3	4

CLUSTER E — AROUSAL / REACTIVITY

D9

Being 'superalert' or watchful or on guard.

☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
0	1	2	3	4

D10

Having difficulty concentrating.

☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
0	1	2	3	4

Scoring note: $PCL5_Subset = D1 + D2 + \dots + D10$ (0–40). Elevated threshold ≥ 19 (proportional to full-scale ≥ 38). Zero respondents exceeded this threshold in this sample — see Report Section 8 for interpretation.

SECTION E — Coping Strategies and Support Access

Purpose: Identifies the support gap (access vs. effectiveness) that is the core business case for the GuardianShield framework. E4 and E7 provide the intervention preference data.

E1

Which of the following coping strategies do you use after reviewing disturbing content at work? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ Talk to a colleague informally about what I reviewed
- ☐ Attend a structured team debrief session
- ☐ Physical exercise (walking, gym, sport)
- ☐ Distancing myself — avoiding thinking about it
- ☐ Journaling or writing about my experience
- ☐ Creative activities (art, music, etc.)
- ☐ Speaking to a counsellor or therapist
- ☐ Social media or entertainment as distraction
- ☐ Substance use (alcohol, tobacco)
- ☐ None — I don't actively cope with it

E2

Of the strategies you selected above, how effective are they at helping you feel better? Rate each one.

Matrix scale: 1 (Not at all effective) → 5 (Very effective). Displayed only for strategies selected in E1.

E3

How satisfied are you with the level of mental health support provided by your employer?

Linear scale: 1 (Very dissatisfied — support is absent or inadequate) → 5 (Very satisfied — support is comprehensive)

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
1	2	3	4	5
Very				Very
dissatisfied				satisfied

E4

Which of the following support options would be MOST valuable to you? (Choose one)

- ☐ Regular peer check-ins with a colleague
- ☐ Structured team debrief sessions after reviewing disturbing content
- ☐ Access to an on-site or online counsellor
- ☐ Rotation away from difficult content categories periodically
- ☐ Formal limits on daily exposure hours
- ☐ Anonymous reporting channel for well-being concerns
- ☐ None of the above

E5

Has exposure to disturbing content at work ever affected your personal life outside of work?

- ☐ Yes, significantly
- ☐ Yes, occasionally
- ☐ No, I am able to fully separate work from personal life
- ☐ I prefer not to answer

E6

If your workplace offered structured mental health support specifically designed for content review professionals, would you use it?

- ☐ Yes, definitely
- ☐ Probably yes
- ☐ Probably not
- ☐ Definitely not — I would not need it
- ☐ Definitely not — I would not feel comfortable using it

E7

In your own words: What is the single biggest challenge about the mental health aspects of your content review work that your employer currently does not address? *(Optional)*

34 of 60 respondents answered this question. Responses form the basis of the five qualitative themes in Report Section 11.

E8

May we use your anonymised response as part of a presentation to BPO HR teams?

- ☐ Yes, you may use my anonymised response
- ☐ No, please do not include my response in presentations

CLOSING STATEMENT — displayed at end of survey

Thank you for completing this survey. Your responses will help build a better evidence base for supporting content review professionals in the BPO sector. This survey used validated research screening tools (MBI-GS9, PHQ-9, PCL-5). These are research instruments, not clinical assessments. If any questions raised personal concerns about your mental health, you are encouraged to speak with a qualified mental health professional. **Mental health support resources:** iCall: 9152987821 (Mon–Sat, 8am–10pm) NIMHANS Helpline: 080-46110007 Vandrevalla Foundation 24/7 Helpline: 1860-2662-345

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final sample · All responses aggregate-only in analysis